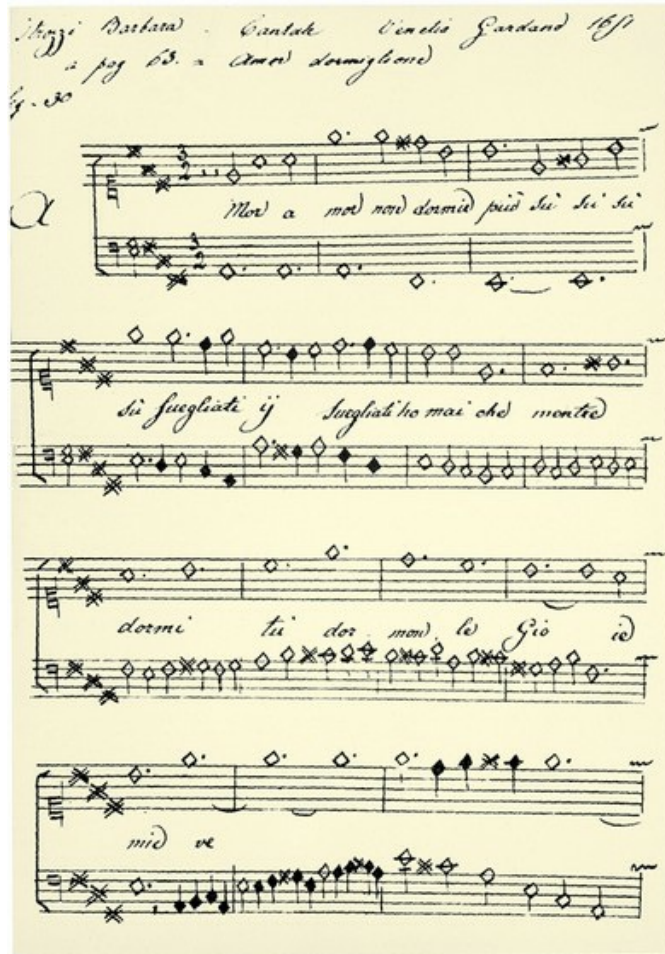


sphere of writing and performing, in the very limited genres of secular vocal and chamber music, to small, elite circles of men (see [box](#)).



CANTATA BY STROZZI

The original piano sheet shown here is in Barbara Strozzi's own handwriting—the composer was an important figure in the development of the Italian cantata.

Finding a voice

Nonetheless, her work was popular in England, Austria, and